

Instant hits: Teams going all out during the PowerPlay has set the stage for flamboyant opening batters like Phil Salt, Travis Head and Abhishek Sharma (in pic). R. V. MOORTHY

Metrics that matter



India has scored at 10.34 runs an over in PowerPlays in 2025, the fastest it has ever batted in the phase.

In 2022, across all T20s, batters accumulated runs at a strike rate of 107.53 through fine leg. Since then, the lowest recorded has been 195.96.

In T20s since 2021, right-handed batters have deployed the reverse sweep at least 200 times against leg-spinners every year. In 2025, it was used 335 times.

The scoring rate through third man has seen an uptick since the turn of the decade, with batters scoring at strike rates in excess of 185, compared to pre-2020 figures that hovered between 160 and 170.

The off-cutter was used more than 1,600 times by pacers in 2025. The leg-cutter, used more sparingly at 204 instances, is nevertheless becoming a more fashionable choice.

The resurgence of the arm-ball is evident in its use by spinners more than 500 times in 2025, with bowlers snaffling 45 wickets at an average of 11.